

Bare Steel and Steel Service Replacement Program Review

Unprotected steel and steel service replacement program review, September 12, 2026. Targets, progress at August 31, leak performance and risks. Presented by Gas Compliance.

Program target

84 miles of unprotected steel main at the end of 2025, to be removed by the end of 2029. 2026 target: 22 miles of main and 2,400 steel services.

Progress at August 31

13.4 miles of unprotected steel main and 1,510 steel services replaced, 61% and 63% of the 2026 targets.

Why steel first

Non-excavation leaks found in 2025 per 100 miles of main: unprotected steel 243, protected steel 75, polyethylene 20. By material: protected steel 876, polyethylene 761, unprotected steel 204, other plastic 11.

Other plastic

4 miles of early-vintage plastic main. Few leaks in absolute terms, but the sample is too small to compare leak rates reliably.

2026 leaks to August

1,360 leaks found: 110 grade 1, 368 grade 2, 882 grade 3; 69 from excavation damage.

System inventory (year-end 2025)

4,980 miles of main: polyethylene 3,720, protected steel 1,172, unprotected steel 84, other plastic 4; 251,000 services.

System inventory (year-end 2025) • extract summary

Measure: main_miles

Unit: miles

Total: 4980.0

Mean: 41.5

Records: 120

Period: 2025-12-31 to 2025-12-31

System inventory (year-end 2025) • extract summary

Measure: services

Unit: services

Total: 251000

Mean: 2091.6667

Records: 120

Period: 2025-12-31 to 2025-12-31

System inventory (year-end 2025) • extract summary

Measure: leaks_repaired_2025

Unit: leaks

Total: 914

Mean: 7.6167

Records: 120

Period: 2025-12-31 to 2025-12-31

Risk ranking and surveys

Corrosion on unprotected steel is the second-ranked DIMP threat after excavation damage. Outside business districts the federal minimum is one survey every five calendar years; we survey unprotected steel areas every three years until the steel is retired.

Funding

Gas pipe replacement is a \$78 million capital program in 2026, recovered through annual interim rate adjustments.